

THE ULTIMATE AI TOOLKIT — 2026 EDITION

# 175 AI Tools Every Category. One Guide.

A curated, category-by-category directory of the AI tools professionals actually use — for chat, research, writing, design, video, audio, code, automation, productivity, marketing, and data.

**175**

TOOLS REVIEWED

**11**

CATEGORIES

**100%**

CURATED & ORGANIZED

# Why This Guide

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New AI tools launch every week, and most directories dump hundreds of names into one overwhelming list. This guide takes a different approach: every tool is placed into a clear, practical category, with the plan type and exact use case spelled out — so you can find the right tool in seconds instead of scrolling for an hour.

Whether you're a founder, marketer, developer, student, or creator, this directory is built to be a working reference you come back to — not a one-time skim.

## Organized by Use Case

11 clear categories, from chat assistants to enterprise data platforms — no digging required.

## Pricing at a Glance

Every tool is tagged Free, Freemium, Paid, or Mixed, so budget filtering takes seconds.

## One-Line Clarity

Each entry tells you exactly what the tool is for — no marketing fluff.

## Built to Reuse

Keep it as your go-to reference whenever you need a new tool for a new job.

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### HOW TO READ THE TAGS

FREE

FREEMIUM

PAID

MIXED PLANS

# What's Inside

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# Chat & AI Assistants

General-purpose conversational AI

**01 ChatGPT**

General chat, writing, and coding help

Free / Freemium / Paid

**02 Claude**

Long-form writing and deep analysis

Free / Freemium / Paid

**03 Gemini**

Everyday assistant and productivity

Free / Freemium / Paid

**04 Perplexity**

AI-powered search and research

Free / Freemium / Paid

**05 Microsoft Copilot**

Office-integrated chat and help

Free / Paid

**06 Grok**

Fast answers on trending topics

Free / Freemium / Paid

**07 DeepSeek**

Strong reasoning and coding

Free / Freemium / Paid

**08 Meta AI**

Social and messaging assistant

Free

**09 Pi**

Conversational companion

Free

**10 Poe**

One subscription, many AI models

Freemium

**11 You.com**

Search and answer engine

Free / Paid

12

### Phind

Developer-focused search assistant

Free / Paid

13

### Character.AI

Custom personas and roleplay

Freemium

14

### HuggingChat

Open-source chat interface

Free

15

### OpenRouter

Gateway to route across many models

Paid

# Research & Knowledge

Literature review and evidence discovery

|    |                                                              |          |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 01 | <b>NotebookLM</b><br>Chat with your own documents            | Free     |
| 02 | <b>Elicit</b><br>Academic research assistant                 | Freemium |
| 03 | <b>Consensus</b><br>Paper search with instant summaries      | Freemium |
| 04 | <b>SciSpace</b><br>Literature review support                 | Freemium |
| 05 | <b>Scite</b><br>Citation verification and context            | Paid     |
| 06 | <b>Semantic Scholar</b><br>Academic paper discovery          | Free     |
| 07 | <b>OpenEvidence</b><br>Medical research support              | Free     |
| 08 | <b>Google Scholar AI tools</b><br>Academic discovery add-ons | Free     |
| 09 | <b>Connected Papers</b><br>Visual paper mapping              | Freemium |
| 10 | <b>Research Rabbit</b><br>Literature exploration graphs      | Freemium |
| 11 | <b>Keenious</b><br>Research recommendation assistant         | Freemium |

12

### Explainpaper

Plain-language paper explanations

Freemium

13

### Perplexity Labs

Advanced research workflows

Paid

14

### ArXiv summary tools

Quick arXiv paper summaries

Freemium

15

### Scholarcy

Auto-generated summary cards

Freemium

# Writing & Content

Drafting, editing, and copywriting

**01 Grammarly**

Grammar, clarity, and tone

Free / Freemium / Paid

**02 QuillBot**

Paraphrasing and rewriting

Free / Freemium / Paid

**03 Jasper**

Marketing copy at scale

Paid

**04 Copy.ai**

Sales and content writing

Freemium / Paid

**05 Writesonic**

Blog and SEO content

Freemium / Paid

**06 Rytr**

Fast short-form copy

Freemium / Paid

**07 Sudowrite**

Creative and fiction writing

Paid

**08 Anyword**

Performance-driven copywriting

Paid

**09 Wordtune**

Sentence-level rewriting

Freemium / Paid

**10 HyperWrite**

All-purpose writing assistant

Freemium / Paid

**11 Notion AI**

Notes, docs, and summaries

Freemium / Paid



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### Coda AI

Docs with embedded workflows

Freemium / Paid

13

### TextCortex

Writing plus research helper

Freemium / Paid

14

### Jenni AI

Academic writing assistant

Freemium / Paid

15

### Writer

Enterprise-grade writing platform

Paid

# Design & Image Generation

Graphics, branding, and visual content

|    |                                                     |                        |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Canva</b><br>Social graphics and quick design    | Free / Freemium / Paid |
| 02 | <b>Adobe Express</b><br>Marketing design templates  | Freemium / Paid        |
| 03 | <b>Figma AI</b><br>UI design and prototyping        | Freemium / Paid        |
| 04 | <b>Framer AI</b><br>Full website generation         | Freemium / Paid        |
| 05 | <b>Uizard</b><br>App and UI mockups                 | Freemium               |
| 06 | <b>Khroma</b><br>AI-curated color palettes          | Free                   |
| 07 | <b>Remove.bg</b><br>Instant background removal      | Freemium               |
| 08 | <b>PhotoRoom</b><br>Product photo editing           | Freemium               |
| 09 | <b>Pixlr</b><br>Browser-based photo editing         | Freemium               |
| 10 | <b>Leonardo AI</b><br>High-quality image generation | Freemium / Paid        |
| 11 | <b>Midjourney</b><br>Premium AI art generation      | Paid                   |

|    |                                                         |                 |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 12 | <b>DALL-E</b><br>Text-to-image generation               | Paid            |
| 13 | <b>Stable Diffusion</b><br>Open-source image generation | Free / Paid     |
| 14 | <b>Playground AI</b><br>Generation and image editing    | Freemium        |
| 15 | <b>Ideogram</b><br>Accurate text-in-image generation    | Freemium        |
| 16 | <b>Krea</b><br>Real-time AI creation                    | Freemium        |
| 17 | <b>Flux</b><br>High-fidelity image model access         | Free / Paid     |
| 18 | <b>Recra</b><br>Vector and brand visuals                | Freemium / Paid |
| 19 | <b>PixAI</b><br>Anime-style image generation            | Freemium        |
| 20 | <b>NightCafe</b><br>Community art generation            | Freemium        |

# Video & Animation

Video creation, editing, and avatars

|    |                                                        |                 |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 01 | <b>Runway</b><br>Advanced video generation and editing | Paid            |
| 02 | <b>Pika</b><br>Quick AI video creation                 | Freemium        |
| 03 | <b>Luma AI</b><br>Video and 3D generation              | Freemium        |
| 04 | <b>Synthesia</b><br>AI avatar-based videos             | Paid            |
| 05 | <b>HeyGen</b><br>Talking avatar videos                 | Freemium / Paid |
| 06 | <b>CapCut AI</b><br>AI-assisted video editing          | Freemium / Paid |
| 07 | <b>Descript</b><br>Audio and video editing by text     | Freemium / Paid |
| 08 | <b>OpusClip</b><br>Auto-generated social clips         | Freemium        |
| 09 | <b>Kaiber</b><br>Animation and stylized video          | Paid            |
| 10 | <b>Lumen5</b><br>Marketing videos from text            | Freemium        |
| 11 | <b>Pictory</b><br>Text-to-video conversion             | Freemium / Paid |

|    |                                                         |                 |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 12 | <b>InVideo AI</b><br>Full video creation suite          | Freemium / Paid |
| 13 | <b>VEED AI</b><br>Online video editing                  | Freemium / Paid |
| 14 | <b>Colossyan</b><br>Training and explainer videos       | Paid            |
| 15 | <b>Animaker</b><br>Animated video creation              | Freemium / Paid |
| 16 | <b>Steve.ai</b><br>Explainer video generation           | Freemium / Paid |
| 17 | <b>Vyond</b><br>Business animation studio               | Paid            |
| 18 | <b>Krikey AI</b><br>Animated 3D avatars                 | Freemium        |
| 19 | <b>DeepBrain AI</b><br>Avatar and broadcast-style video | Paid            |

# Audio & Voice

Music, speech, and meeting capture

|    |                                                 |                 |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 01 | <b>Suno</b><br>Full song generation from text   | Freemium        |
| 02 | <b>Udio</b><br>AI music generation              | Freemium        |
| 03 | <b>Soundraw</b><br>Custom background music      | Paid            |
| 04 | <b>Boomy</b><br>Instant original music tracks   | Freemium        |
| 05 | <b>ElevenLabs</b><br>Realistic voice generation | Freemium / Paid |
| 06 | <b>Murf</b><br>Professional voiceovers          | Paid            |
| 07 | <b>Resemble AI</b><br>Voice cloning platform    | Paid            |
| 08 | <b>PlayHT</b><br>Text-to-speech generation      | Freemium / Paid |
| 09 | <b>Krisp</b><br>Background noise cancellation   | Freemium / Paid |
| 10 | <b>Otter.ai</b><br>Live transcription           | Freemium / Paid |
| 11 | <b>Fireflies.ai</b><br>Automated meeting notes  | Freemium / Paid |

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### Fathom

Meeting summaries and highlights

Free / Freemium

13

### tl;dv

Meeting recording and highlights

Freemium

14

### Grain

Shareable call clips

Freemium / Paid

15

### Auphonic

Automatic audio cleanup

Freemium / Paid

16

### Podcastle

Podcast recording and editing

Freemium / Paid

# Coding & Development

AI pair programmers and dev tools

|    |                                                           |                 |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 01 | <b>GitHub Copilot</b><br>In-editor code completion        | Paid            |
| 02 | <b>Cursor</b><br>AI-native code editor                    | Freemium / Paid |
| 03 | <b>Replit AI</b><br>Build and ship apps in-browser        | Freemium / Paid |
| 04 | <b>Codeium</b><br>Free coding assistant                   | Free / Paid     |
| 05 | <b>Tabnine</b><br>Private, secure autocomplete            | Freemium / Paid |
| 06 | <b>v0 by Vercel</b><br>Generate UI from a prompt          | Freemium        |
| 07 | <b>Aider</b><br>Terminal-based pair programming           | Free            |
| 08 | <b>Bolt.new</b><br>Rapid app prototyping                  | Freemium / Paid |
| 09 | <b>Sourcegraph Cody</b><br>Codebase-aware AI assistant    | Freemium / Paid |
| 10 | <b>Amazon Q Developer</b><br>AWS-integrated dev assistant | Paid            |
| 11 | <b>JetBrains AI</b><br>AI built into JetBrains IDEs       | Paid            |



|    |                                                 |                 |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 12 | <b>Continue</b><br>Open-source coding assistant | Free            |
| 13 | <b>Tabby</b><br>Self-hosted code completion     | Free            |
| 14 | <b>Windsurf</b><br>AI-guided coding workflow    | Freemium / Paid |
| 15 | <b>Cline</b><br>Autonomous coding agent         | Free            |

# Automation & Agents

Connect apps and automate workflows

|    |                                                   |                 |
|----|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 01 | <b>Zapier AI</b><br>No-code app automation        | Freemium / Paid |
| 02 | <b>Make</b><br>Visual workflow automation         | Freemium / Paid |
| 03 | <b>Lindy</b><br>Custom AI assistants and agents   | Paid            |
| 04 | <b>Dify</b><br>Build and deploy AI apps           | Freemium        |
| 05 | <b>Flowise</b><br>Visual LLM workflow builder     | Free            |
| 06 | <b>LangChain</b><br>Framework for AI applications | Free            |
| 07 | <b>LangGraph</b><br>Stateful agent workflows      | Free            |
| 08 | <b>n8n</b><br>Self-hostable automation            | Free / Paid     |
| 09 | <b>Pipedream</b><br>Fast API integrations         | Freemium / Paid |
| 10 | <b>Bardeen</b><br>Browser-based automation        | Freemium / Paid |
| 11 | <b>Gumloop</b><br>No-code AI workflows            | Freemium / Paid |

12

### Zaplink

Automated task pipelines

Freemium / Paid

13

### Relay.app

AI-powered team automation

Freemium / Paid

14

### Browse AI

Web data extraction and monitoring

Freemium / Paid

15

### Adept-style agents

Task-executing AI agents

Paid

# Productivity & Meetings

Planning, scheduling, and notes

01

**Notion AI**

Docs, notes, and task help

Freemium / Paid

02

**Coda AI**

Docs and databases combined

Freemium / Paid

03

**Motion**

Automated scheduling and planning

Paid

04

**Reclaim AI**

Smart calendar automation

Freemium / Paid

05

**Sunsama**

Daily planning and focus

Paid

06

**ClickUp AI**

AI-assisted project management

Freemium / Paid

07

**Asana AI**

Work management insights

Paid

08

**Monday AI**

AI-assisted work planning

Paid

09

**Trevor AI**

Visual task scheduling

Freemium / Paid

10

**Superhuman AI**

Faster email workflows

Paid

11

**Otter.ai**

Meeting transcription

Freemium / Paid

12 **Fireflies.ai**  
Meeting intelligence and search

Freemium / Paid

13 **Fathom**  
Automated meeting summaries

Free / Freemium

14 **tl;dv**  
Recordings, notes, and clips

Freemium

15 **Grain**  
Meeting highlight reels

Freemium / Paid

# Business, Support & Marketing

Customer support, CRM, and growth

01

**Intercom Fin**

Automated customer support

Paid

02

**Tidio AI**

Support chatbot for websites

Freemium

03

**Drift**

AI-powered sales chat

Paid

04

**HubSpot AI**

CRM and marketing automation

Freemium / Paid

05

**Hootsuite OwlyWriter**

AI social media content

Paid

06

**Buffer AI**

Social media scheduling

Freemium / Paid

07

**Mailchimp AI**

Email marketing automation

Freemium / Paid

08

**Jasper Marketing**

Marketing content at scale

Paid

09

**Copy.ai GTM**

Sales workflow content

Paid

10

**Smartwriter AI**

Personalized outreach emails

Freemium / Paid

11

**Persana AI**

AI-driven lead generation

Paid

|    |                                                    |                 |
|----|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 12 | <b>Apollo AI</b><br>Sales prospecting database     | Paid            |
| 13 | <b>Lavender</b><br>Email coaching and optimization | Freemium / Paid |
| 14 | <b>Surfer AI</b><br>SEO-optimized content          | Paid            |
| 15 | <b>Frase</b><br>SEO briefs and content             | Freemium / Paid |
| 16 | <b>SEO.ai</b><br>AI-assisted SEO writing           | Paid            |

# Data, Analytics & Enterprise

ML platforms and enterprise-grade AI

|    |                                                              |             |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 01 | <b>DataRobot</b><br>Enterprise machine learning              | Paid        |
| 02 | <b>Databricks AI</b><br>Analytics and ML at scale            | Paid        |
| 03 | <b>Snowflake Cortex</b><br>AI built into the data cloud      | Paid        |
| 04 | <b>Tableau GPT</b><br>Conversational analytics               | Paid        |
| 05 | <b>Power BI Copilot</b><br>AI-assisted business intelligence | Paid        |
| 06 | <b>MindsDB</b><br>AI directly inside databases               | Free / Paid |
| 07 | <b>H2O.ai</b><br>Open ML platform                            | Free / Paid |
| 08 | <b>Cohere</b><br>Enterprise-grade language models            | Paid        |
| 09 | <b>Mistral</b><br>Open and hosted LLMs                       | Free / Paid |
| 10 | <b>Replicate</b><br>Run models via simple API                | Paid        |
| 11 | <b>Hugging Face</b><br>Models, datasets, and hosting         | Free / Paid |



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## Modal

Serverless AI compute

Free / Paid

13

## Anyscale

Distributed AI compute at scale

Paid

14

## Vectara

AI-powered search and retrieval

Paid

# Get the Most Out of This Guide

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Three ways to use this directory well:

- **Start with your budget.** Filter by the Free and Freemium tags before considering paid plans.
- **Match the category to your task first.** Don't pick a tool by hype — pick it by the job it's built for.
- **Revisit it monthly.** The AI landscape moves fast; treat this as a living reference, not a one-time read.

## Enjoyed this guide?

Share it with your team, bundle it into your own resource library, or use it as the foundation for client onboarding and consulting sessions.